ORDER OF SAINTS FRANCIS AND CLARE

THE OSFC SCHOOL OF FRANCISCAN FORMATION

FORMATION WITHOUT WALLS

A Full Prospectus for the Correspondence Formation Programme

From Enquiry to Lifelong Franciscan Formation

Study deeply · Pray faithfully · Live the Gospel where you are · Walk the journey with others

Pax et Bonum

Welcome to Formation Without Walls

The Order of Saints Francis and Clare is a dispersed Franciscan religious family. Its members ordinarily live their vocation in homes, families, workplaces, parishes, neighbourhoods and local communities rather than in one residential religious house. The formation programme is therefore designed to reach those places and to test Franciscan life within them.

Correspondence formation is not treated as an inferior substitute for residential formation. It is a deliberate method of study, prayer, practical experiment, written reflection, accompaniment and review. The ordinary circumstances of life become part of the formation environment: prayer is tested beside household responsibility, simplicity enters a real budget, fraternity is practised across distance, and service is undertaken among actual neighbours.

What the programme seeks to form

The programme aims at integrated Franciscan discipleship rather than the mere completion of lessons. Academic understanding matters, but formation also attends to prayer, emotional honesty, healthy relationships, safeguarding, accountability, ordinary reliability, service, family and work responsibilities, and the freedom to continue, pause or leave.

The central question is not simply whether a student can describe Franciscan ideals, but whether the Gospel is becoming credible in the pattern of daily life.

Our central conviction
The place where Franciscan life will ordinarily be lived should also become one of the principal places where Franciscan formation is tested.

The Correspondence Formation Method

Each course belongs to an ongoing relationship between student, Formation Companion, fraternity, Scripture, Franciscan tradition and lived experience. The recurring cycle is:

RECEIVE · STUDY · PRAY	**REFLECT · PRACTISE · SUBMIT**	**FEEDBACK · CONVERSE · APPLY**
Receive structured material, engage Scripture and Franciscan sources, and take the subject into prayer.	Test the teaching in ordinary life and submit selected evidence of engagement.	Receive response, discuss learning and formation evidence, and carry an agreed objective forward.

Why correspondence formation suits a dispersed Order

Formation happens in real life

The student does not postpone Franciscan living until a later stage. Gospel values are tested in money, work, household, disagreement, prayer, care, time, rest and local service.

Distance becomes intentional fraternity

Communion cannot be taken for granted when members do not share one building. Formation therefore develops reliable communication, mutual care, shared prayer and appropriate digital contact.

Written work slows discernment down

Writing makes it possible to distinguish evidence from impression, while written response creates a continuing record of formation dialogue.

Private prayer remains private

Formal evidence can be supplied through essays, source studies, practical reports and defined assignments without requiring routine surrender of intimate prayer journals.

Formation is broader than academic achievement

Coursework is read alongside whole-person formation. Strong writing cannot substitute for safe boundaries, fraternity, reliability, teachability or service.

Accessibility need not mean superficiality

Methods may be adapted appropriately for disability, health, caring responsibilities, work patterns or geography while maintaining the seriousness of formation.

The Whole Formation Journey

Progression
ENQUIRY → POSTULANCY → NOVITIATE → TEMPORARY PROFESSION → PREPARATION FOR PERPETUAL PROFESSION → PERPETUAL PROFESSION → LIFELONG FORMATION

The programme is progressive. Postulancy establishes foundations; Novitiate moves into systematic Franciscan and religious formation; temporary profession tests the promises over time; final preparation gathers the whole journey before lifelong profession; continuing formation keeps profession oriented towards continual conversion.

Four formation pillars

Human and emotional maturity

Self-awareness, truthful communication, healthy conflict, relational stability and response to correction.

Spiritual accountability

Prayer, Gospel conversion, teachability, conscience and servant leadership.

Pastoral and psychological safety

Healthy boundaries, safeguarding, use of power, consent and appropriate help-seeking.

Practical fruit

Reliable service and observable integration of Franciscan values within ordinary life.

Important

Course completion contributes evidence to formation, but completion of pages, assignments or time does not by itself create an entitlement to progression.

Stage 0 — Enquiry: Come and See

OSFC-F001 — Come and See: Discerning the Franciscan Way

A gentle introductory programme for those exploring whether Franciscan spirituality and OSFC may be a place in which to discern further.

Principal areas:

- What Franciscan spirituality is
- Meeting Francis and Clare
- Christ and the Gospel
- Dispersed religious life
- Prayer and fraternity
- Simplicity, service and peace
- Family, work and ordinary responsibility
- Understanding the formation journey

Formation purpose: To permit informed enquiry without pressure to apply. Clearer discernment is a good outcome whether it leads towards Postulancy or elsewhere.

Stage I — Postulancy: Certificate in Franciscan Foundations

Postulancy asks whether attraction to Franciscan spirituality can begin becoming a sustainable form of Gospel life. The eight-course sequence establishes the language, habits and responsibilities needed for deeper Novitiate formation.

OSFC-101 — Vocation, Discernment and the Franciscan Call

Establishes a mature theology and practice of vocation.

Principal areas:

- Baptismal vocation
- Attraction, calling and aptitude
- Mixed motives and purification
- Personal history and self-knowledge
- Freedom and informed consent
- Family, work, health and finance
- Ecclesial discernment
- The Formator relationship

Formation purpose: To replace romantic certainty with free, grounded and ecclesial discernment.

OSFC-102 — Jesus Christ and the Holy Gospel

Places Christ, rather than religious identity itself, at the centre of the Franciscan vocation.

Principal areas:

- Incarnation and hidden life
- Kingdom of God
- Beatitudes and Sermon on the Mount
- Parables and healing
- Calling and formation of disciples
- Cross and Resurrection
- Responsible interpretation of Scripture
- Lectio divina
- Gospel ethics

Formation purpose: To form candidates who read Scripture responsibly, pray carefully and translate the Gospel into ordinary conduct.

OSFC-103 — Francis of Assisi: Conversion and Gospel Life

Studies Francis historically, spiritually and practically rather than as a romanticised symbol.

Principal areas:

- Medieval Assisi
- Crisis and conversion
- Mercy and encounter
- San Damiano and repair
- Poverty and minority
- Fraternity
- Work and mission
- Peace and creation
- Francis and the Church

Formation purpose: To move from admiration of Francis to appropriation of Gospel movements such as mercy, simplicity, minority, fraternity, peace, service and continual conversion.

OSFC-104 — Clare of Assisi: Contemplation and Courage

Introduces a complementary Franciscan school of contemplation, steadfastness, poverty and communal care.

Principal areas:

- Clare's vocation
- San Damiano
- Poverty and the poor Christ
- The Mirror of Christ
- Clare's letters, Rule and Testament
- Mutual care
- Authority and ecclesial courage
- Perseverance

Formation purpose: To show that Clarean contemplation leads to imitation of Christ, faithful community, endurance and courageous responsibility.

OSFC-105 — Learning to Pray as a Franciscan

Builds a prayer life capable of surviving ordinary circumstances.

Principal areas:

- Morning and Evening Prayer
- Psalms and the Divine Office
- Scripture and lectio divina
- Silence and contemplation
- Intercession
- Eucharistic spirituality
- Dryness and distraction
- Prayer during illness
- A sustainable personal rhythm

Formation purpose: To move prayer from aspiration into stable, adaptable practice.

OSFC-106 — Understanding OSFC Religious Life

Explains the form of religious life into which the student is discerning.

Principal areas:

- Religious life and baptism
- Franciscan charism
- Dispersed OSFC identity
- Rule, Constitutions and Customary
- Personal Rule
- Religious profession
- Authority and conscience
- Habit and insignia
- Financial responsibility

Formation purpose: To support informed consent and responsible understanding of profession, authority and ordinary civil, Church and family responsibilities.

OSFC-107 — Fraternity, Family, Work and Dispersed Life

Locates Franciscan vocation within ordinary relationships and responsibilities.

Principal areas:

- Fraternity as gift
- Communication and mutual care
- Digital fraternity
- Conflict and reconciliation
- Marriage and dependants
- Caregiving
- Employment and retirement
- Sabbath and recreation

- Hospitality
- Home as friary

Formation purpose: To test whether Franciscan commitment strengthens responsible household, work and fraternal life.

OSFC-108 — Safe, Healthy and Accountable Religious Life

Establishes the safety culture required before deeper religious formation.

Principal areas:

- Christian dignity and power
- Consent and boundaries
- Spiritual authority
- Privacy, confidentiality and secrecy
- Safeguarding and reporting
- Pastoral and digital boundaries
- Financial boundaries
- Complaints and fair process
- Correction and accountability
- Health and appropriate help-seeking

Formation purpose: To establish safeguarding, boundaries and accountability as part of Franciscan spirituality itself.

End of Postulancy
Course completion is gathered with prayer, practical evidence, fraternity, service, Formation Companion feedback and whole-person review before discernment concerning admission to Novitiate.

Stage II — Novitiate: Diploma in Franciscan Formation

The Novitiate is the systematic heart of initial formation. It moves from introductory understanding into sustained engagement with primary Franciscan sources, theology, religious life, mission and accountable ecclesial practice.

Part I — Franciscan Sources

OSFC-201 — The Earlier Rule

The developing Franciscan form of life in its evangelical and historical setting.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-202 — The Later Rule

The mature canonical Rule and faithful contemporary appropriation.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-203 — The Testament of Saint Francis

Francis's vocational memory of mercy, brothers, Church and Gospel life.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-204 — The Admonitions and Prayers of Francis

Interior poverty, humility, knowledge, correction, praise and prayer.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-205 — The Writings of Saint Clare

Clare in her own voice through letters, Rule and Testament.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-206 — Early Franciscan History and Development

Growth, tensions, ecclesial recognition and diversity in the early movement.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

Part II — Franciscan Theology and Spirituality

OSFC-301 — The Incarnation and Franciscan Christology

Contemplation of the humble and self-giving Christ.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-302 — Prayer, Psalms and the Divine Office

Mature common and personal prayer.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life

- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-303 — Lectio Divina and Contemplative Prayer

Attentive Scripture-based contemplation.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-304 — Eucharistic Spirituality

Sacramental reverence joined to self-giving service.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-305 — Conversion, Penance and Reconciliation

Repentance, repair, mercy and beginning again.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-306 — Discernment and Conscience

Mature moral and spiritual judgement.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

Part III — The Evangelical Life

OSFC-401 — Simplicity and Poverty of Spirit

Possessions, money, stewardship, generosity and freedom from possessiveness.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-402 — Chastity According to State of Life

Truthful, faithful and appropriately bounded relationships suited to one's state of life.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-403 — Obedience and Responsible Freedom

Listening, conscience, legitimate authority and accountability held together.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context

- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-404 — Minority and Servant Authority

Leadership that refuses domination, clericalism and status-seeking.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-405 — Fraternity and Mutual Care

The discipline of enduring communion, correction and care.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-406 — The Personal Rule of Life

Drafting, testing and revising the pattern by which the common Rule becomes daily life.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

Part IV — Franciscan Life in the World

OSFC-501 — Marriage, Family and Household

Integrating profession with legitimate family bonds and responsibilities.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-502 — Work, Vocation and Stewardship

Franciscan discipleship through ordinary labour, duty and responsible use of resources.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-503 — Service, Mission and the Works of Mercy

Mission expressed through proportionate, competent and accountable service.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-504 — Peace, Reconciliation and Non-Domination

Peacemaking that joins mercy, truth, justice and safe boundaries.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation

- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-505 — Care of Creation

Franciscan kinship with creation translated into attainable practice.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-506 — Church, Parish and Local Community

Living the charism in communion, service and responsible local belonging.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

Part V — Safe and Accountable Religious Life

OSFC-601 — Safeguarding and Boundaries

Safeguarding culture, consent, boundaries and reporting.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-602 — Authority, Conscience and Accountability

Responsible exercise and reception of authority.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-603 — Conflict, Correction and Fair Process

Healthy disagreement, correction, complaint and procedural fairness.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-604 — Pastoral and Digital Conduct

Safe presence in pastoral, online and communications settings.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-605 — Health, Dependency and Appropriate Help

Truthful limits, support and appropriate professional help.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

OSFC-606 — Integration and Novitiate Review

Drawing together evidence of growth, difficulty and readiness.

Principal areas:

- Scripture and theological foundation
- Franciscan tradition and primary sources
- OSFC life and proper-law context
- Prayer and reflection
- Practical application in dispersed life
- Formation conversation and review

Formation purpose: To deepen the novice's ability to receive the Franciscan tradition faithfully and embody it safely, prayerfully and responsibly in contemporary dispersed life.

Stage III — Temporary Profession

Temporary profession shifts the emphasis from learning the vocabulary of the life to testing its stability over time. The precise study plan should be set within the Order's proper law and the individual formation plan. A suitable correspondence pattern may include continuing work in the Rule, personal Rule of life, prayer, fraternity, mission, evangelical counsels, leadership, safeguarding and regular reviews of lived fruit.

Purpose of the stage
To test whether professed commitments can be lived with increasing steadiness, freedom, accountability and charity in ordinary circumstances, rather than only understood in theory.

Stage IV — Preparation for Perpetual Profession

Final preparation gathers the whole journey. It should review vocation, the evangelical counsels, prayer, fraternity, mission, human maturity, safeguarding, health, family and work responsibilities, the Personal Rule, and the candidate's understanding of the lifelong nature of profession. A final synthesis portfolio and structured formation conversations can provide evidence, but the decision remains a whole-person discernment rather than an academic award alone.

Purpose of the stage
To support a free, informed and mature discernment concerning lifelong profession, with sufficient evidence that the form of life has become sustainable and integrated.

Stage V — Lifelong Formation

Perpetual profession is not the end of formation. Continuing formation should retain the same Gospel rhythm of study, prayer, practice, conversation and review, with particular attention to changing responsibilities, health, ministry, leadership, relationships, new learning and the continuing call to conversion.

What a Student Receives

- A Student Course Book with learning outcomes, teaching and guided study.
- Required Scripture and Franciscan source readings appropriate to the course.
- Practical exercises that translate learning into ordinary life.
- A Workbook or reflection structure where appropriate.
- An Assignment Portfolio identifying the selected work to be submitted.
- Formation conversation prompts for discussion with the Formation Companion.
- Written feedback and an agreed next formation objective.
- A completion record or certificate where the course requirements have been satisfactorily engaged.

Assessment: Formation Rather Than Grades

The correspondence system uses formation-oriented outcomes rather than treating the programme as a competitive academic qualification. Existing assignment material uses the following outcome language:

Outcome	Meaning
E	Engaged satisfactorily
D	Developing
FR	Further reflection required
R	Resubmission required
FC	Formation conversation required

A course may include essays, source study, case work, practice reports and a final synthesis. Assignments should acknowledge sources, protect confidential third-party information and disclose material AI or digital assistance.

The Formation Companion

The Formation Companion accompanies rather than replaces conscience. Their role is to help the student notice patterns, engage the material truthfully, connect study with lived conduct, receive correction, and review practical objectives. Formation conversations also provide a place to identify difficulties that a written assignment alone cannot disclose.

Accessibility, Health and Ordinary Responsibilities

OSFC formation is intended to be serious without assuming that every candidate has identical health, work, family, caring or geographical circumstances. Appropriate adaptations can support real participation. Such flexibility should serve genuine formation and should not lower standards of safeguarding, integrity or responsible commitment.

Privacy, Safeguarding and Academic Integrity

- Private spiritual material should not be demanded merely as proof of devotion.
- Formal submissions should protect information about third parties.
- Scripture and spiritual authority must not be used to override conscience, safeguarding or lawful responsibility.
- Sources should be acknowledged responsibly.
- Material AI or digital assistance should be disclosed when required by the assignment framework.
- Safeguarding concerns and serious risks are handled according to the Order's proper policies and lawful responsibilities.

Certificates and Records

The programme already provides a course-certificate structure for the enquiry and postulancy courses. Certificates record satisfactory completion of a course within the OSFC correspondence formation programme. They should be understood as records of course completion within formation, not as automatic guarantees of admission, profession, office or advancement.

How the Programme Fits Together

The formation movement
LEARN → PRAY → LIVE → REFLECT → DISCERN → REVIEW → CONTINUE

The strength of the system lies in repetition at a deeper level. Scripture is revisited with greater maturity; Franciscan sources move from introduction to close study; prayer moves from establishing a rhythm to sustained contemplation; the evangelical counsels move from explanation to tested practice; fraternity develops from participation into mutual responsibility; and safeguarding and accountability remain present throughout rather than being treated as one isolated topic.

For Enquirers and Candidates

An enquirer does not need to arrive already formed. The programme begins with Come and See precisely so that attraction can be explored with freedom. Those who continue are invited progressively into more demanding study, prayer, practice, correspondence and accompaniment. The aim is truthful discernment: to discover whether the Franciscan way, lived in the particular form of OSFC, leads to a freer and more faithful gift of self to God and neighbour.

A Note on Canonical and Constitutional Authority

This prospectus describes the educational and formative architecture of the correspondence programme. It is not intended to replace or amend the Rule, Constitutions, Customary, safeguarding requirements or other proper law of the Order. Where any question of admission, status, profession, authority or procedure arises, the governing texts and competent authority of OSFC remain determinative.

Closing Invitation

Formation Without Walls takes seriously a simple Franciscan conviction: the Gospel must become life where the person actually is. Home, work, parish, neighbourhood, fraternity and service are not interruptions to formation. They are among the places in which formation becomes true.

Pax et Bonum